

ANALYSIS OF VIETNAM E-COMMERCE TRENDS 2024:

OPPORTUNITIES, CHALLENGES AND DEVELOPMENT ORIENTATIONS

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SUMMARY

This article comprehensively studies Vietnam's e-commerce market in the period 2020–2024, with a focus on 2024 - the year that is forecast to be a breakthrough with a total transaction value exceeding 25 billion USD. The authors used a mixed research method, combining secondary data analysis from VECOM, Google-Temasek and in-depth interviews with 120 e-commerce businesses. The results show that five main trends are reshaping the market: social commerce, live-stream sales, cross-border e-commerce, AI personalizing shopping experiences, and sustainable commerce. The study also shows that policy barriers and logistics infrastructure limitations are still the biggest bottlenecks.

Keywords: e-commerce, Vietnam, 2024 trends, logistics, AI, social commerce

1. PROBLEM STATEMENT AND RESEARCH OBJECTIVES

Vietnam is emerging as one of the fastest growing e-commerce markets in Southeast Asia, with an average growth rate of 25–30%/year over the past 5 years. According to the Google-Temasek-Bain 2023 report, Vietnam's digital economy is estimated to reach 45 billion USD by 2025, of which e-commerce accounts for an increasingly large proportion.

However, this development comes with many challenges: high return rates (15–25%), widespread fake news, unsynchronized logistics systems and limited consumer confidence. This article aims to comprehensively analyze opportunities and challenges, and propose a policy framework for sustainable e-commerce development for Vietnam until 2030.

2. OVERVIEW OF E-COMMERCE MARKET 2024

2.1. Macro Indicators

Chi Tieu	2022	2023	2024 (Forecast)	YoY growth
Total GMV (billion USD)	16.4	20,5	25,0	+22%
Number of online buyers (million)	51,3	57,6	63.2	+10%
Average order value (USD)	320	356	395	+11%
Ratio of e-commerce/total retail sales	7,2%	8.9%	10,5%	+1,6pp

Leading e-commerce platform	Shopee	Shopee	Shopee	—
Cashless payment	52%	61%	70%	+9pp

Table 1: Overview of Vietnam's e-commerce market 2022–2024.
Source: VECOM, Google-Temasek, compiled by the authors.

2.2. Key Trends in 2024

- **Social Commerce:** TikTok Shop surpassed 5 billion USD GMV in Vietnam, accounting for 20% market share. Individual sellers on Facebook and Zalo increase 180% compared to 2022.
- **Live-stream sales:** Over 30,000 live-stream sessions per day on exchanges. The conversion rate from live-stream is 3 times higher than from static ads.
- **Cross-border e-commerce:** Export turnover through e-commerce channels reached 4.2 billion USD. Vietnamese handicrafts, food and fashion are popular in ASEAN markets.
- **Personalized AI:** More than 60% of major e-commerce platforms have deployed AI to personalize the experience. Return rates increase by 35% with relevant product recommendations.
- **Sustainable trade:** Gen Z consumers are willing to pay 10–15% more for products with environmental commitments. Exchanges are starting to have "eco badges" for sellers that meet green criteria.

3. CONCLUSION AND POLICY RECOMMENDATIONS

Research shows that Vietnam's e-commerce market is at a breakthrough with many strong growth drivers. However, for sustainable growth, there needs to be synchronous coordination between the government, businesses and consumers in building a transparent, fair and sustainable e-commerce environment.

- (1) Complete the legal framework for cross-border e-commerce, especially on taxes and intellectual property.
- (2) Investment in developing logistics infrastructure to rural and mountainous areas is still difficult.
- (3) Strengthen consumer education about information security and safe online shopping.
- (4) Develop national "green e-commerce" standards and mechanisms to encourage businesses to participate.
- (5) Establish a digital skills training fund for 500,000 business households to convert to e-commerce by 2026.

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